ICE SKATING ASSOCIATION OF MALAYSIA

NATIONAL SYNCHRO9 TEAM

ATHLETE CODE OF CONDUCT AND COMMITMENT

Applicable to athletes participating in the ISAM National Synchro9 Development Programme and National Team Pathway

Formal Athlete Policy Document

Version: September 2026

1. PURPOSE

The ISAM National Synchro9 Programme is a national team programme and a team sport environment.

Many athletes entering Synchro9 may come from an individual figure skating background, where training, competition results and personal progression are primarily centred on the individual skater.

Synchro9 requires a fundamentally different approach.

The success of a synchronized skating team depends not only upon the technical ability of individual athletes, but upon the ability of nine athletes to skate, train, communicate and perform as one unit.

Athletes must therefore demonstrate:

- teamwork;
- discipline;
- commitment;
- reliability;
- respect;
- adaptability;
- accountability;
- communication;
- coachability;
- awareness of others; and
- willingness to place the needs of the team alongside individual ambitions.

Selection into the National Synchro9 Programme is both a privilege and a responsibility. Every athlete is expected to uphold the standards of the Ice Skating Association of Malaysia (ISAM) and conduct herself in a manner appropriate for an athlete participating in a Malaysian national sports programme.

> **FUNDAMENTAL PRINCIPLE: No individual athlete is more important than the team.**

2. GOVERNING STANDARDS AND REFERENCES

This Athlete Code of Conduct forms part of the standards governing participation in the ISAM National Synchro9 Programme.

It should be read together with applicable rules, regulations, safeguarding requirements and policies issued or recognised by:

- Ice Skating Association of Malaysia (ISAM);
- International Skating Union (ISU);
- Kementerian Belia dan Sukan Malaysia (KBS);
- Majlis Sukan Negara Malaysia (MSN);
- Institut Sukan Negara (ISN); and

- other relevant Malaysian authorities and sporting bodies where applicable.

Athletes shall comply with the most current applicable rules and policies.

2.1 International Skating Union - ISU

The ISU Code of Ethics establishes standards of conduct and integrity for persons involved in ISU activities, including skaters, coaches, team leaders and other athlete-support personnel. It also provides safeguards intended to protect participants from harassment and abuse and to protect the integrity and reputation of skating.

The ISU Athlete Safeguarding framework recognises the right of athletes to participate and develop in sport in a safe, inclusive and respectful environment.

Accordingly, athletes participating in the National Synchro9 Programme are expected to conduct themselves consistently with principles relating to:

- integrity;
- respect;
- athlete welfare;
- safeguarding;
- non-discrimination;
- prevention of bullying and harassment;
- responsible behaviour;
- appropriate communication; and
- protection of the integrity and reputation of skating.

For athletes under 18, safeguarding and welfare considerations are of particular importance.

2.2 Kementerian Belia dan Sukan Malaysia - Kod Sukan Selamat

The National Synchro9 Programme supports the principles established through the Kod Sukan Selamat / Safe Sport Code of the Kementerian Belia dan Sukan Malaysia (KBS).

The Kod Sukan Selamat promotes a sporting environment in which participants are protected from abuse, harassment, violence and inappropriate conduct.

Accordingly, the National Synchro9 Programme shall not tolerate behaviour including:

- bullying;
- harassment;
- intimidation;
- humiliation;
- discrimination;
- psychological abuse;
- physical abuse;
- sexual misconduct;
- retaliation against persons raising legitimate concerns; or
- other conduct that threatens the welfare or safety of an athlete.

Athletes are expected to contribute positively to a safe and respectful sporting environment.

2.3 Majlis Sukan Negara Malaysia - MSN

The National Synchro9 Programme recognises the role of Majlis Sukan Negara Malaysia (MSN) within Malaysia's national high-performance sports system and its implementation and promotion of Safe Sport principles.

Athletes participating in a national programme are expected to demonstrate standards consistent with a national sporting environment, including:

- discipline;
- accountability;
- professionalism;
- respect;
- commitment;
- appropriate behaviour;
- athlete welfare;
- responsible communication; and
- cooperation within a national team structure.

Participation in a National Team Programme therefore involves responsibilities extending beyond an athlete's individual sporting performance.

2.4 Institut Sukan Negara - ISN

The National Synchro9 Programme recognises the role of Institut Sukan Negara (ISN) in Malaysia's high-performance sports ecosystem and the importance of integrity, accountability and professional conduct within national sport.

Athletes interacting with ISN personnel, programmes, services or facilities are expected to behave professionally and comply with applicable instructions, policies and procedures.

3. THE TEAM-FIRST PRINCIPLE

Every National Synchro9 athlete must demonstrate a genuine willingness and ability to operate as part of a team.

- put team objectives ahead of personal preferences;
- understand that individual skating ability alone does not guarantee selection;
- accept that formations and roles may change;
- support teammates regardless of personal friendships;
- cooperate with athletes from different clubs, rinks and coaching backgrounds;
- make reasonable adjustments for the benefit of the team;
- understand that synchronized skating requires athletes to adapt to one another; and
- recognise that every athlete contributes to team performance and morale.

An attitude that consistently places personal preference above the reasonable needs of the team is incompatible with Synchro9.

4. TRANSITION FROM INDIVIDUAL FIGURE SKATING TO SYNCHRO9

ISAM recognises that many athletes entering this programme may have spent several years training primarily as individual figure skaters.

Synchro9 requires athletes to develop additional skills.

- adjust her speed to match teammates;
- modify stride length;
- change timing;
- control edges differently;
- maintain spacing rather than skate independently;
- prioritise formation accuracy over individual expression;
- repeat basic movements numerous times;
- accommodate differences between skaters;
- accept a position that is not personally preferred; and
- prioritise uniformity over individual style.

These adjustments are part of the discipline of synchronized skating and should not be interpreted as a reduction of an athlete's individual ability.

The objective is to make nine capable individual skaters function as one synchronized team.

5. RESPECT FOR TEAMMATES

Every athlete shall treat every teammate with dignity and respect.

The following behaviour will not be tolerated:

- insulting or degrading remarks;
- shouting at teammates;
- humiliation;
- mocking another athlete's mistakes;
- mocking ability, appearance or background;
- malicious gossip;
- deliberately excluding teammates;
- bullying;
- intimidation;
- harassment;
- hostile or passive-aggressive conduct;
- spreading rumours;
- attempting to turn teammates against another athlete;
- retaliation;
- deliberate undermining; or
- repeated disrespectful behaviour.

Athletes are not required to be close friends with every teammate.

They are required to be respectful, professional, cooperative and capable of working together.

6. TEAM COHESION AND A SAFE TEAM ENVIRONMENT

A national high-performance team cannot function effectively when interpersonal conflict becomes more important than training.

Athletes are expected to demonstrate maturity in managing relationships.

Conduct that negatively affects team cohesion may include:

- repeatedly creating personal conflicts;
- bringing friendship-group disagreements into training;
- encouraging teammates to choose sides;
- forming hostile cliques;
- deliberately excluding another athlete;
- unnecessary confrontation;
- malicious gossip;
- repeatedly creating tension within the group;
- hostile communication;
- public outbursts directed at teammates;
- deliberately undermining another athlete; or
- repeatedly bringing outside disputes into the national team environment.

Having emotions, concerns or disagreements is normal.

How an athlete manages those disagreements is part of being a National Team athlete.

7. COMMUNICATION

Athletes shall communicate respectfully with teammates, coaches, Team Managers, ISAM officials, technical personnel, support staff and competition officials.

Athletes shall:

- speak respectfully even when frustrated;
- listen while instructions are being given;
- raise concerns appropriately;
- avoid arguments during training;
- accept constructive feedback;
- ask questions respectfully;
- communicate attendance issues promptly; and
- respond within a reasonable time when team confirmations are required.

8. TEAM WHATSAPP AND DIGITAL COMMUNICATION

Official WhatsApp groups and other team communication channels are extensions of the National Team environment.

They shall not be used for:

- arguments;

- personal attacks;
- sarcastic or humiliating remarks;
- public criticism of teammates;
- hostile messages;
- gossip;
- circulating rumours;
- deliberately excluding relevant team members;
- sharing private conversations to embarrass another person; or
- encouraging others to take sides in disputes.

Disagreements requiring resolution should be referred privately to the appropriate coach, Team Manager or ISAM official.

9. ATTENDANCE AND COMMITMENT

Synchro9 depends upon the participation of the entire team. One athlete's absence can affect formations, spacing, choreography and the training of eight other athletes.

Athletes are therefore expected to:

- attend compulsory training;
- arrive punctually;
- arrive prepared;
- inform coaches of unavoidable absences as early as reasonably possible;
- avoid unnecessary absences;
- prioritise confirmed National Team commitments;
- participate fully in training;
- complete off-ice or video assignments;
- learn assigned choreography;
- retain corrections between sessions; and
- remain mentally engaged throughout training.

Repeated absenteeism or lateness may affect continued selection.

10. RELIABILITY

Reliability is an essential selection criterion for synchronized skating.

Athletes shall not repeatedly:

- confirm attendance and subsequently withdraw without reasonable justification;
- cancel at the last minute;
- miss important rehearsals;
- arrive late without notice;
- fail to learn assigned choreography;
- fail to respond to important team communications;
- make themselves unavailable immediately before a competition;
- fail to complete agreed responsibilities; or
- expect the team programme to continually change around personal convenience.

When one athlete is unreliable, eight other athletes are affected.

11. TRAINING ATTITUDE

Athletes shall:

- follow coaching instructions;
- maintain concentration;
- minimise unnecessary talking while coaches are teaching;
- give appropriate effort;
- support teammates when mistakes occur;
- reset quickly following mistakes;
- avoid blaming others;
- receive corrections professionally;
- remain constructive when frustrated; and
- contribute to a productive training environment.

Repeated conduct such as eye-rolling directed at coaches or teammates, walking away while being addressed, deliberately ignoring instructions, shouting, swearing at another person, throwing equipment in anger, or repeated disrespectful body language may be addressed as misconduct.

12. MISTAKES AND BLAME

Mistakes are inevitable while developing a synchronized team.

Athletes must not automatically blame another teammate when a formation breaks, an intersection fails, timing is incorrect, spacing changes, someone falls, an element does not work, or a programme requires repetition.

The appropriate response is to identify the problem with the coaching team, correct it and repeat the element.

Synchro9 requires a culture of: "How do we fix this together?" rather than "Whose fault was that?"

13. ACCEPTANCE OF TEAM ROLES

Coaches may determine formation positions, line positions, wheel positions, intersection positions, pairings, lead positions, substitutes or alternates, competition line-ups, performance responsibilities, changes to choreography and other technical assignments.

Such decisions may take into consideration:

- skating ability;
- synchro skills;
- timing;
- consistency;
- height;

- speed;
- edge quality;
- spatial awareness;
- compatibility between skaters;
- attendance;
- reliability;
- attitude;
- safety; and
- overall team requirements.

An athlete may respectfully ask about a decision. She may not pressure, bully or undermine another athlete to obtain a preferred position.

14. COACHING DECISIONS

Athletes shall respect the authority of the appointed National Synchro9 coaching and technical structure. Constructive questions are welcome.

Athletes shall not:

- disrespectfully challenge coaches;
- repeatedly argue over coaching decisions;
- encourage teammates to disregard instructions;
- deliberately create divisions between coaches;
- manipulate one coach against another;
- deliberately practise conflicting choreography without approval; or
- use parents or private coaches to exert inappropriate pressure on the National Team coaching structure.

Legitimate concerns may be raised through the appropriate channels.

15. CLUBS, RINKS AND PRIVATE COACHES

The National Synchro9 Programme brings together athletes from different skating clubs, academies, rinks, private coaches and training backgrounds.

During National Synchro9 activities, athletes become members of one National Team programme.

Club rivalry, rink politics or private coaching disputes must not be brought into the National Team environment.

Athletes shall not:

- insult another athlete's coach;
- insult another athlete's club;
- create rivalry between clubs;
- recruit athletes away from coaches during national activities;
- use the programme to settle external disputes; or
- allow loyalty to an individual club to interfere with National Team cooperation.

16. CONFLICT RESOLUTION

Disagreements should initially be handled calmly and respectfully where appropriate.

If the matter cannot be resolved, athletes should approach the designated Team Captain, Team Manager, Coach or ISAM Official depending on the nature and seriousness of the issue.

Athletes must not conduct campaigns among teammates to gather support against another athlete.

The purpose of conflict resolution is to restore a professional and functional team environment - not to establish popularity or factions.

17. SAFEGUARDING

Nothing in this Code prevents an athlete from reporting bullying, harassment or abuse; raising a safeguarding or safety concern; reporting inappropriate conduct; seeking assistance; reporting an injury or illness; or raising a genuine welfare concern.

Athletes will not be disciplined merely for raising a genuine concern in good faith.

Safeguarding concerns shall be handled appropriately and, where necessary, separately from normal team disciplinary matters.

Deliberately false allegations or deliberate misuse of safeguarding procedures may themselves be addressed appropriately, following fair review.

18. SOCIAL MEDIA

Athletes must remember that their conduct online can affect teammates and the National Team.

Athletes shall not post, share or circulate content that:

- humiliates a teammate;
- bullies or harasses another person;
- reveals confidential team information;
- exposes internal disputes;
- publishes private conversations without appropriate justification;
- attacks coaches or officials;
- deliberately damages another teammate's reputation; or
- brings the National Team or ISAM into disrepute.

Sensitive training footage, choreography or behind-the-scenes information should not be published without appropriate authorisation.

19. CONFIDENTIALITY

Athletes shall respect the confidentiality of matters including:

- athlete selection discussions;
- internal coaching discussions;
- team strategy;
- choreography under development;

- disciplinary matters;
- safeguarding matters;
- teammate medical or personal information;
- competition planning; and
- other matters identified as confidential.

Privacy between teammates shall also be respected.

20. PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT WHEN REPRESENTING MALAYSIA

When attending competitions, camps, seminars, official functions, international travel, media activities or other official National Team activities, athletes are representatives of Malaysia and ISAM.

Athletes are expected to:

- behave courteously;
- respect officials and volunteers;
- respect competitors;
- comply with schedules;
- follow venue rules;
- wear required team attire;
- follow delegation instructions;
- maintain appropriate conduct in public; and
- avoid behaviour that could damage the reputation of the National Team.

21. ACCOUNTABILITY

Athletes are expected to take responsibility for their own actions.

When mistakes occur, athletes should be capable of:

1. acknowledging the mistake;
2. accepting appropriate feedback;
3. apologising where appropriate;
4. correcting the behaviour; and
5. moving forward.

Repeatedly blaming teammates, coaches, parents, officials or circumstances instead of accepting personal responsibility is inconsistent with the standards expected of a National Team athlete.

22. TEAM CULTURE

Every athlete contributes to team culture.

RESPECT | DISCIPLINE | COMMITMENT | TEAMWORK | ACCOUNTABILITY | HUMILITY | INTEGRITY | PROFESSIONALISM | NATIONAL PRIDE

Athletes should actively protect these values.

23. SELECTION IS CONTINUOUS

Selection into the National Synchro9 Programme does not guarantee permanent membership or competition selection.

Athletes may continue to be assessed throughout the programme on technical factors including skating performance, synchro ability, timing, formations, consistency, spatial awareness, programme execution and technical development.

Team factors may include attendance, reliability, punctuality, commitment, teamwork, communication, adaptability, coachability, discipline, attitude, behaviour and contribution to team culture.

An athlete who possesses strong individual skating skills may therefore not necessarily be selected ahead of an athlete who demonstrates greater reliability, synchro suitability and ability to function effectively within the team.

Technical talent does not override behaviour that repeatedly damages the team.

24. COMPETITION LINE-UP

Being selected into the development squad does not automatically guarantee selection into every competition line-up.

Competition selection may take into account:

- technical readiness;
- synchro performance;
- attendance;
- commitment;
- physical readiness;
- reliability;
- conduct;
- team compatibility; and
- requirements of the particular programme or event.

Competition selection decisions shall be made through the appropriate ISAM National Team structure.

25. WITHDRAWAL FROM TEAM COMMITMENTS

Where an athlete has formally accepted participation in a camp, competition, programme or other major team commitment, the athlete should not subsequently withdraw without reasonable grounds.

Athletes and parents should understand that late withdrawal may affect:

- choreography;
- formations;
- competition entries;
- replacement athletes;

- travel arrangements;
- accommodation;
- coaching plans;
- team expenditure; and
- the preparation of the entire team.

Where withdrawal is unavoidable, ISAM should be informed as early as reasonably possible.

Repeated unjustified withdrawal from confirmed commitments may be considered when determining future selection.

26. PARENTS AND GUARDIANS

Where athletes are minors, parents and guardians play an important supporting role.

Parents should communicate concerns through the appropriate coaching or management structure.

Parents must not:

- confront another minor athlete;
- reprimand another athlete;
- interfere directly in athlete disputes;
- encourage conflict between athletes;
- attempt to influence other athletes against a teammate;
- undermine appointed coaches; or
- use team communication channels to conduct personal disputes.

Concerns should instead be referred to the Team Manager, Coach or designated ISAM representative.

27. DIFFERENCE BETWEEN PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND SAFEGUARDING

Normal coaching actions such as correcting technique, changing formations, changing positions, selecting a different competition line-up, requiring additional training, setting performance expectations or providing constructive feedback do not automatically constitute bullying or harassment.

Likewise, genuine bullying, harassment or safeguarding concerns must not be dismissed simply as "team drama", "personality differences" or "normal sport".

Each matter shall be considered according to its circumstances.

28. DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

Depending upon seriousness, frequency and circumstances, ISAM may apply progressive disciplinary measures.

Stage 1 - Guidance / Verbal Counselling

The athlete is informed of the concern and the expected improvement. This stage may be used for minor or first-time behavioural concerns.

Stage 2 - Formal Warning

The athlete may receive a formal written warning identifying the behaviour of concern, previous discussions where relevant, required improvements and consequences of recurrence. For a minor athlete, the parent or guardian may be informed.

Stage 3 - Behaviour or Commitment Review

The athlete may be required to attend a meeting involving appropriate members of the coaching team, Team Manager, ISAM representative and parent or guardian where appropriate. A defined behavioural or commitment review period may be established.

Stage 4 - Team Consequences

Where appropriate, consequences may include modification of team responsibilities, reassignment of a position, temporary removal from a particular activity, removal from a competition line-up, temporary suspension from team activities or other proportionate measures. Safety, safeguarding requirements and applicable rules shall always take precedence.

Stage 5 - Removal from the Programme

Repeated misconduct, serious misconduct, persistent failure to meet commitment standards or behaviour that substantially damages the functioning or safety of the team may result in removal from the National Synchro9 Programme. ISAM may move directly to a later disciplinary stage where the seriousness of an incident reasonably warrants it.

29. SERIOUS MISCONDUCT

Serious misconduct may include, without limitation:

- bullying;
- harassment;
- threats;
- physical aggression;
- serious verbal abuse;
- discrimination;
- deliberate humiliation;
- serious insubordination;
- retaliation;
- behaviour placing another athlete at risk;
- serious breach of confidentiality;
- deliberate sabotage of team activities; or
- conduct that significantly compromises athlete welfare or the integrity of the National Team.

Serious concerns may result in immediate temporary measures pending appropriate review.

Where a matter involves safeguarding, ISAM safeguarding procedures and any applicable reporting requirements shall take precedence.

30. FAIRNESS IN DISCIPLINARY MATTERS

Where disciplinary action is considered, athletes should be:

- informed of the concern;
- given an appropriate opportunity to respond;
- treated respectfully;
- assessed according to the circumstances of the case; and
- subject to proportionate action.

For athletes under 18, appropriate parent or guardian involvement should be included subject to safeguarding requirements.

Disciplinary processes should not be used to punish athletes for raising genuine safeguarding concerns in good faith.

31. THE SYNCHRO9 STANDARD

Every athlete joining this programme must understand:

> **You may arrive as an individual figure skater. You are being developed to become a synchronized skater.**

The strongest Synchro9 athlete is not necessarily the athlete with the highest individual technical score.

A successful Synchro9 athlete combines technical ability with:

- consistency;
- awareness;
- adaptability;
- timing;
- trust;
- reliability;
- discipline;
- humility;
- communication; and
- commitment to eight other athletes.

> **The National Synchro9 Programme therefore develops athletes not only as skaters - but as teammates.**

32. NATIONAL TEAM PLEDGE

As members of the ISAM National Synchro9 Programme, we recognise that:

> **WE SKATE AS NINE.**

We accept that every athlete has different strengths, personalities and backgrounds. We will respect those differences. We will communicate. We will be accountable. We will support one another. We will work through disagreements professionally. We will accept corrections. We will

arrive prepared. We will honour our commitments. We will protect our teammates. We will represent Malaysia with pride.

And when we enter the ice as Synchro9 - we succeed or fail together as one team.

33. ATHLETE DECLARATION

I confirm that I have read and understood the ISAM National Synchro9 Team Athlete Code of Conduct and Commitment.

I understand that participation in the National Synchro9 Programme requires more than technical skating ability.

I understand that my attendance, reliability, behaviour, discipline, attitude, teamwork, communication, coachability and commitment may form part of my continued assessment and selection.

I agree to respect my teammates; respect coaches and officials; fulfil my team commitments; communicate appropriately; avoid conduct that damages team cohesion; accept coaching and team decisions professionally; protect confidential team matters; raise concerns through appropriate channels; and uphold standards expected of an athlete representing Malaysia.

I understand that failure to comply with this Code may result in disciplinary action in accordance with applicable ISAM procedures, including possible suspension or removal from the National Synchro9 Programme.

Athlete

Full Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Parent / Guardian

Required where the athlete is under 18 years of age.

Full Name: _____

Relationship to Athlete: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

For ISAM

Name: _____

Designation: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

34. REFERENCE FRAMEWORK

This Code has been developed with reference to the principles contained in:

6. International Skating Union (ISU) - Code of Ethics 2025, including provisions concerning conduct, integrity, athlete welfare, harassment, abuse and safeguarding.
7. International Skating Union - Athlete Safeguarding Policy and Skate Aware safeguarding framework, including principles concerning safe, inclusive and respectful participation in skating.
8. Kementerian Belia dan Sukan Malaysia - Kod Sukan Selamat / Safe Sport Code, concerning the creation of safe sporting environments and the prevention and management of abuse, harassment and violence in sport.
9. Majlis Sukan Negara Malaysia (MSN) Safe Sport implementation and athlete-welfare initiatives within Malaysia's national sporting system.
10. Relevant integrity and professional-conduct principles within the Institut Sukan Negara (ISN) high-performance sports environment.
11. Applicable Ice Skating Association of Malaysia (ISAM) Constitution, regulations, policies, safeguarding procedures, selection policies and disciplinary requirements, as amended from time to time.
12. Applicable Malaysian legislation and regulatory requirements concerning sports administration, safeguarding and athlete welfare.

Where a mandatory rule, regulation or law imposes a higher or more specific requirement than this Team Code, that mandatory requirement shall prevail.

END OF DOCUMENT